

OUTLIERS

# Capture

Layer 3 of 4 · Filling it without typing,  
then something that reads what arrives.

# Who is going to write all this down?

If the answer is you, at a keyboard, then what you have built is a filing job with your name on it.

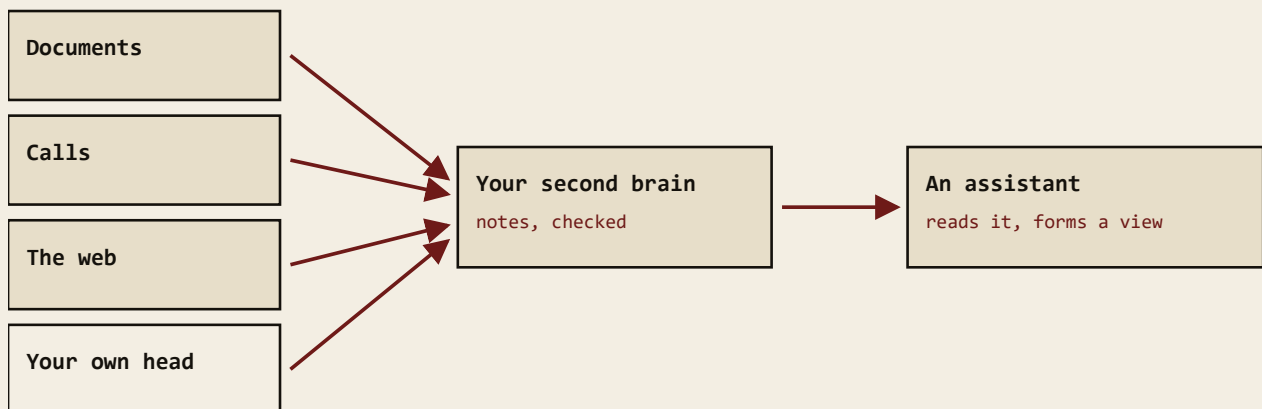
## WHAT THE LAST LAYER LEFT YOU WITH

You have a sound place to put things and a check that keeps it sound. What you do not have is anything putting things in it. Every note so far exists because you decided to sit down and write it.

## WHAT THIS LAYER BUILDS

Four ways in, matching the four ways material actually reaches a business: long documents, spoken word, the web, and your own head. Each one gets something that turns it into notes without you retyping it.

Then the two kinds of help that read what arrives. A skill is a job written down once and done the same way every time. An assistant is given a single job, its own instructions, and permission to use particular things and nothing else - and unlike a skill, it forms a view.



The fourth way in is the one nobody else can supply, and the one everybody skips.

FOUR WAYS IN; ONE PLACE THEY ALL LAND

## How it works

Volume first. Sorting is what the layer beneath is for.

**Long documents.** Handing over a four hundred page book and asking for a summary wastes the book. It gets read in sections, captured on the author's own terms first, and only then translated into what it means for your work. Two passes, because doing both at once produces neither.

**Spoken word.** The most valuable material in most businesses is said out loud and never written down. A recording becomes text on your own machine, and the text becomes four things worth keeping: what was decided, what was promised and by whom, what was learned, and who was mentioned. The transcript stays as the record; those four are what you use.

**The web.** One click saves a page into your system as text, with where it came from and when already filled in. A source that changes later cannot quietly change what you believed.

**Your own head.** Decisions and the reasoning behind them, what you charge and why, what you refuse, what you changed your mind about. Everything else is other people's material. This is the part that makes the answers sound like you.

**Skills and assistants.** A skill is the repeatable job - format this, file that, run the same seven steps. An assistant is for the jobs where the answer is not the same every time. Judge one the way you would judge a person doing the task: you already know what good and bad look like, and that is the whole standard.

# Build it

One command. It asks you a few questions so what you get is yours, then does the work.

```
git clone https://github.com/OUTLIERS-ai/outliers-sb-03-capture
cd outliers-sb-03-capture
python install.py
```

This layer needs Layers 1 and 2. Notes arriving faster than you can read them is exactly why the check underneath has to be in place first.

## WHAT IT ASKS YOU, AND WHY

| QUESTION                                   | WHAT IT CHANGES                                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>What do you record calls with?</b>      | Picks the route from recording to text. If nothing yet, it sets up the one that runs on your own machine and uploads nothing. |
| <b>Install the assistants now?</b>         | Adds the ones that read documents, books, calls and research. They can be added later without redoing anything.               |
| <b>Anything you want it to never read?</b> | Folders named here are left alone by everything in this layer.                                                                |

## WHAT YOU END UP WITH

A set of ways in, a small group of assistants each with one job, and one command you use constantly to throw something into the system without deciding where it goes.

# Using it

Put more in than feels sensible, and tidy none of it.

Organising is the reflex that kills these systems, because it feels like progress and produces nothing. A messy system with four hundred real documents in it beats a beautiful one with twelve. You cannot find a connection in material you have not loaded.

Once a reasonable amount is in, ask it the question that tests the whole layer: what do you now know about my business that I never told you directly. A thin answer means it needs more material. An answer that surprises you means it has crossed from a filing cabinet into a memory.

IF YOU ALREADY HAD SOMETHING LIKE THIS

If material is already flowing in, the test is whether any of it is yours rather than other people's. Ask for everything it holds on how you price, what you refuse, and what you changed your mind about. Most systems come back nearly empty on all three, and that is the gap this layer is really for.

WHAT THIS LAYER LEAVES UNSOLVED

You now have several assistants working, each capable of writing into the foundation everything else stands on, and one of them will eventually be pointed at something that reaches another human being. Nothing currently sequences them, limits them, or stops one checking its own work and passing it. That needs control built into the machinery rather than written in the instructions, because instructions are what a busy system stops reading first.

NEXT: LAYER 4 • OPERATIONS

What runs when, limits shared across everything at once, nothing reaching a person without your hand on it, and the record that lets you see whether any of it is working.

WORDS USED IN THIS GUIDE

|            |                                                                                                                        |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Assistant  | A single-purpose helper with its own written instructions and permission to use particular things and nothing else.    |
| Skill      | A job written down once and performed the same way every time. No judgement involved, which is what makes it reliable. |
| Transcript | The text of something that was spoken, produced on your own machine so the recording never leaves it.                  |